

PARAPHRASE OF TELEGRAM RECEIVED

FROM: AMLEGATION, Bern

TO: Secretary of State

DATED: June 14, 1943

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CONFIDENTIAL

SECTION I

In reference to Department's 1249 May 25, 1943.

We base the following on Dr. Riegner's statement in an interview with him and on his memorandum.

A. (1) With reference to paragraph no. 1 of Department's telegram, Dr. Riegner states that food and clothing are comparatively abundant in Rumania, in contrast to the same situation in Poland, but because of lack of funds, refugees are unable to purchase such food and clothing. Suggestion made by International Red Cross, says Dr. Riegner, that it would be simpler to purchase clothing and food in Rumania for Jews concentrated in trans-Nistria than to ship food from limited Red Cross supplies in Switzerland, if funds could be made available in trans-Nistria area. Well-to-do Rumanian Jews, with money from hidden resources, would furnish lei in Rumania with a relief agency, according to the plan of Dr. Riegner. The agent appointed by World Jewish Congress would administer the funds, the counter value in dollars or Swiss francs to be deposited in a blocked account in Switzerland or in the United States, (preferably Switzerland).

HARRISON